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Contractor. Applied AI Engineer. Builder.
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10 years of experience

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The Short Version

I architect systems that ship. Led 12 engineers at Whitestone. Built maps and map making tools at Grab. Wrote a game engine from scratch because I wanted to understand rendering. I read both code and literature, since the understanding of language has become integral in a world of LLMs.

I understand that my way of work might be frowned upon, but results don't lie. Waiting for Jira tickets,estimating work and waiting for meetings to happen is my very own Kafkaesque nightmare, it's not efficient and it's wasteful.

PS: If you're a human, ask me about the time I tried to prompt inject an ATS. It didn't work, but it made for a good interview story

What I actually do

*I build systems that work. Full stop. **Maps, WebGL engines, payment solutions, MCP servers**, I've shipped them all. I make technical decisions based on data, not hype. I write code that doesn't disappoint. I lead teams by showing them how, I lead LLMs by telling them how. I have the experience, I have the wits and I can adapt quickly. I solve problems by understanding how each decision impacts every other one and how to design and build precisely what is needed to solve the problems. **Personalized medicine, but for software.***

SKILLS

AI/ML:
MCPs, Agentic workflows, RAG, Multimodal (image/text), Local models (Ollama), Fine-tuning, Prompt engineering that works

Programming Languages:
JavaScript, TypeScript, C/C++ (with WASM as well), Go, Java

Frameworks:
NodeJS, React, Redux, MongoDB, Next.JS, Angular, Bun, HTMX, SpringBoot

Databases:

MongoDB, SQL (mySQL & MariaDB)

Cloud:

Azure, Vultr, some AWS

Tools:
Jira, Cursor, nvim, Open Code, VSCode, various debuggers and profilers, Docker, KVMs

Environments (OS):
Linux (preferred), Windows and MacOS

Everything else:

Any tool that helps shipping or solving a problem.

Where I've done it

Grab | Applied AI Engineer - Maps R&D

May 2024 - Present | Bucharest (Remote)

I worked in an R&D manner in order to explore, develop and deliver custom mapping solutions based on either preexisting data or by building a data gathering solutions from scratch. I used a lot of AI tools both for building those products and for processing and transforming large amounts of data. I created MCPs to help with different software integrations between services and tools and I used all the major AI platforms and even ran and optimized models locally (using ollama). I used image text analysis to extract information out of them and pipe it to custom tool AI agent tool calls in order to store and transform it into "mappable" information.

Impact: More accurate mapping for the business related logistics.

Whitestone Software | Frontend Team Lead

September 2022 - May 2024 | Bucharest (Remote)

Took over a team of 12, a legacy codebase of over one million LOC, and a mandate to modernize without breaking production. Refactored everything into modular components, built a WebGL engine, cut load times from 13s (I know) to 1.2s. Grew four juniors into mid-levels. Conducted 50+ interviews. Left the codebase better than I found it.

Impact: 50k daily active users, zero downtime migration and a good foundation to build further.

OC Prod | Full Stack Engineer

June 2020 - September 2022 | Bucharest (Remote)

Among other things, I rewrote a dying checkout & payment system for **boots.com**, the old one was to be deprecated. New API, new framework, faster, more streamlined experience. The deadlines were

LANGUAGES

Romanian - Native
English - Fluent
French - Basic

Impact: An online store without checkout and payments doesn't exist

DPD Romania | Full Stack Engineer

November 2019 - May 2020 | Bucharest

Built payment automation for 500+ freelance drivers. Vehicle types, contract rules, dynamic quotas—complex business logic. I made it work.

Impact: We enabled the business to expand and hire delivery contractors, which alleviated costs and fulfilled the demand.

UpTrek | *Full Stack Engineer (Solo Developer)*

May 2018 - November 2019 | Bucharest

Built a modern web platform from scratch, alone, in 18 months. Node, React, MongoDB, auth, deployment, the works. Learned Clean Code the hard way—by writing shit code and fixing it.

Impact: 100+ vacation packages sold by the time I left. Still running.

Simplity | *Junior Fullstack Developer*

October 2016 - May 2018 | Bucharest

I learned the ropes: unit and integration testing, git, how to actually code in a collaborative environment, what Agile and SCRUM means, etc.

OPEN SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

Kaboomer (2026) - A wifi based audio playback device. Alexa with a web interface and without the spying. (based on the same raspberry pi as the KittyKam)

KittyKam (2025) - A cat monitor built from spare parts I had laying around (webcam + raspberry pi). I used hamachi and a nginx proxy on an external server to view it remotely.

Agiat (2025) – Taiga spelled backwards, it's a decentralized version of Taiga. The idea was for people to own and host their own data (using the internal browser DB functionality) and to have servers to just intermediate the transfer of data, without storing anything.The implementation is buggy, but it is inspired

by peer to peer technology (with an intermediary to not get personal data exposed to strangers).

Go Game Engine (2024) – I was curious how I can use SDL in Go, which is a much better language than TypeScript, unfortunately it doesn't compile to WASM (at the time of writing this).

NoClip (2023) – Server-rendered platform with Bun + TypeScript + HTMX. Proof that you don't need a frontend framework. Tech choices with intent, not resume padding.

Game Engine (2023) – Pure TypeScript, no frameworks. Vector math, sprite animations, 60fps with 500+ sprites. Building an RPG engine because I wanted to understand rendering. WebGPU next.

WASM Experiments (2023) – C → WASM renderer. Learned that WASM is fast but DOM interop is painful. Chose pure TypeScript after benchmarking..

Taiga (2016) – Interest-based chat platform. Built before Facebook Rooms. Taught me that timing matters and architecture scales.

Babel (2014) – C++/OpenGL roguelike. Ubisoft game jam. 48 hours, 4 friends, we didn't win. Still proud.

Hobbies

I co-run a classical literature book club. Dostoevsky, Woolf, Hemingway. We do close readings because language is the most complex system we'll ever touch. Every word carries weight, every sentence has structure. LLMs taught me that ambiguity kills—novels taught me how to spot it.